



△ KEEPING COMPANY

Schools of small fish often swim around the heads of whale sharks, possibly for protection.

◁ SUCTION FEEDING

A whale shark often holds its mouth close to the surface during suction feeding, opening and closing it to suck in water as well as food.

- ↔ 40 ft (12m)
- ⚖ 13.2 tons (12 metric tons)
- ⊗ Vulnerable
- 🌊 Phytoplankton, zooplankton
- 🏠 🌴 🌊



Tropical and temperate waters worldwide

When feeding, a whale shark filters enough water to fill an Olympic-sized swimming pool every 100 minutes